

Electric car in India

GM plans to come out with an electric car sometime next year



Palm Pre 2 arrives

Palm Pre 2 sporting the all new webOS 2.0 operating system from HP, launched in France and will enter US and Canada markets soon

Microsoft Arc Touch Mouse sends lesser mice scurrying, plays a fashionable Pied Piper

Microsoft has unveiled the Arc Touch Mouse and it's just as unconventional as the first one. The Arc Touch Mouse moulds itself from curved to flat, and can be used on nearly any surface, tracing with its 2.4 GHz Nano transceiver and Microsoft BlueTrack technology. The option of the flat position also makes the Arc Touch more portable than its predecessor. Featuring a capacitive touch and scroll sensitive strip, it does away with the

mouse wheel, though Microsoft tried to retain the effect – using haptic feedback to make little vibrations and a little speaker to make little clicks, all to simulate the feel of a mouse wheel.

The sleek Arc Touch Mouse is 15 mm thick and certainly a fashion statement. It offers new ways to interact with the computer, with its touch and scroll sensitive strip and haptic feedback. Even the flat position would have been an interesting way to control the mouse, if Microsoft had built that into the design. The Arc

Touch Mouse apparently went through 50 prototype designs to create, and the consensus over the web is that while the mouse might not be just perfect yet, it does point to a new path for mice everywhere, leaving us looking forward to even more innovative designs and interface possibilities in the near future.

The Arc mouse is of course, wireless – using two AAA batteries for power that lasts six months on a single charge. It's available for pre-order right



now for a price of \$69.95. The Arc Touch Mouse ships in December, and will be broadly available online and in stores this January **d**

Flex in a week

This video training course will help you understand how you can use Adobe's Flex framework to build your own Rich Internet Applications (RIA's). You must be familiar with basic programming constructs and processes and have a basic knowledge of XML, HTML and CSS.

The course consists of videos and exercises organised into training modules. If you do get stuck (as all learners are expected to), the 'Flex in a week' forum is also available to help you out of your jam.

For more information, head over to <http://goo.gl/uqq3>.



Intel's new upgradable processors yours; for \$50

It appears you could soon be bringing home a (comparatively) cheaper computer with an Intel Pentium G6951 processor, and be able to upgrade it by purchasing a \$50 (currently ₹2,291) card. The card comes with a code which can be used by the Intel's Upgrade Application to unlock features in your computer. The upgrade could double the amount of L3 cache, and improve HyperThreading support, doubling the number of threads, which is a substantial upgrade indeed.

Upgrading hardware is decidedly more difficult than upgrading software, which is one of the reasons why even hardware devices such as your CD/DVD ROM drive, motherboard and many other such devices, have the firmware.

This means that any bugs detected in the hardware even after manufacture can possibly be fixed by updating the firmware.

This however is not a new concept. Processors routinely come with features such as entire cores locked, however this is usually done due to faulty components rather than a means to derive further profit. Even in these cases, for those willing to take a risk, there are means available to unlock and use the blocked features. If you buy a copy of Windows Vista or Windows 7, your disc already contains all versions from the lowliest Home Basic to the Ultimate. However, the version installed depends on the key used during installation, and is a matter of convenience for them to be on the same disc.

What Intel is doing has key differences from the cases highlighted above. First of all this is not being done because of faulty components, and if it was, \$50 is way too much to ask for adding instability to your system. Intel has also already charged you for the hardware you bought and paid for, recovering the cost and making a profit. This is like purchasing a refrigerator with the freezer compartment locked, and the key for extra. Even so, the fact of the matter is, if you had an option between purchasing two refrigerators which cost the same, one without a freezer and the other locked, you might find it wiser to invest in the one with better future prospects.

Anyone want to place a bet on how long it will take before this gets hacked? **d**